

US Containment of Communism Topical Paper 1 Past Year Paper Questions 2025-2021

0470/11/O/N/25

- 8 The involvement of the United States in Vietnam was often controversial.
- (a) What was the Strategic Hamlet Program? [4]
 - (b) Why was the Gulf of Tonkin Incident important? [6]
 - (c) 'The United States withdrew from Vietnam because of American public opinion.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 8 The United States attempted to contain communism with varying degrees of success.
- (a) Describe the involvement of the United States in the Korean War. [4]
 - (b) Why was Vietnamisation important? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that the Cuban Missile Crisis was a disaster for Khrushchev? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The United States took action against communism in several different parts of the world.
- (a) Describe the part played by China in the Korean War. [4]
 - (b) Why did Kennedy impose a naval blockade on Cuba in October 1962? [6]
 - (c) 'It was an error for the United States to become involved in Vietnam.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Attempts by the United States to stop communism spreading were sometimes successful.
- (a) What happened in the Tet Offensive? [4]
 - (b) Why was the Cuban Missile Crisis important? [6]
 - (c) How far did the United States fail to achieve its aims in the Korean War? Explain your answer. [10]

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8 US presidents had several international crises to deal with in the 1960s and 1970s.

- (a) What was 'Vietnamisation'? [4]
- (b) Why was there opposition in the United States to the Vietnam War? [6]
- (c) Who handled the Cuban Missile Crisis better: Kennedy or Khrushchev? Explain your answer. [10]

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7 The Cuban Missile Crisis was a serious threat to world peace.

- (a) Who was Fidel Castro? [4]
- (b) Why did the United States object to the Soviet Union placing nuclear missiles on Cuba? [6]
- (c) Who gained more from the Cuban Missile Crisis: Kennedy or Khrushchev? Explain your answer. [10]

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7 The outbreak of the Korean War tested the American policy of containment.

- (a) Describe events in Korea between June and September 1950. [4]
- (b) Why was General MacArthur dismissed from command of the UN forces in Korea? [6]
- (c) Which was more successful in the Korean War: North Korea or the USA? Explain your answer. [10]

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7 The United States did not achieve its aims in Vietnam.

- (a) What was the 'draft'? [4]
- (b) Why was the impact of the Tet Offensive disastrous for the United States? [6]
- (c) How far was Vietnamisation responsible for the ending of the Vietnam War? Explain your answer. [10]

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8 In the 1960s US foreign policy was dominated by the fight against communism.

- (a) Describe what happened at the Bay of Pigs in 1961. [4]
- (b) Why was it important that Kennedy refused to accept the Soviet Union building missile sites in Cuba? [6]
- (c) How successful were Nixon's policies in Vietnam? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/O/N/23

- 7 In 1950 tensions in Korea escalated into war.
- (a) What was Truman's attitude to the North's invasion of South Korea? [4]
 - (b) Why did North Korea invade South Korea in 1950? [6]
 - (c) 'The Korean War was a victory for the United Nations.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/M/J/23

- 8 During the Cold War US and Soviet leaders had difficult problems to deal with.
- (a) What were the Paris Peace Accords of 1973? [4]
 - (b) Why was President Kennedy humiliated by the failure of the Bay of Pigs invasion? [6]
 - (c) 'Placing missiles in Cuba achieved Khrushchev's aims.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 American involvement in Vietnam was eventually unsuccessful.
- (a) What was the Vietcong? [4]
 - (b) Why did President Johnson increase American involvement in Vietnam? [6]
 - (c) 'American public opinion was more important than the tactics of the North Vietnamese forces in causing the United States to withdraw.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/O/N/22

- 7 American policies in the Cold War were not always successful.
- (a) What was the policy of 'containment'? [4]
 - (b) Why did Khrushchev place nuclear missiles in Cuba? [6]
 - (c) How surprising is it that the United States did not win the Vietnam War? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/M/J/22

- 8 The United States was faced with challenges in various parts of the world.
- (a) Describe MacArthur's role in the Korean War. [4]
 - (b) Why did Kennedy go ahead with the Bay of Pigs invasion in 1961? [6]
 - (c) 'It was the United States' strategy and tactics that led to its failure in Vietnam.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/M/J/22

- 7 The United States reacted to communism in different parts of the world.
- (a) Describe how Eisenhower reacted to the Cuban revolution of 1959. [4]
 - (b) Why did the American policy of 'search and destroy' in Vietnam create problems? [6]
 - (c) Was the Korean War a defeat for North Korea? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 US involvement in the Cold War was not always popular.
- (a) What was the Gulf of Tonkin incident? [4]
 - (b) Why did US public opinion turn against the Vietnam War? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that the US failed to contain the spread of communism? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The USA was involved in both Cuba and Vietnam.
- (a) Describe what happened during the Tet Offensive. [4]
 - (b) Why was the Bay of Pigs incident important? [6]
 - (c) 'US involvement in Vietnam was an error from the beginning.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/M/J/21

- 7 The USA had an interventionist foreign policy in the 1950s and 1960s.
- (a) Describe the tactics used by the Vietcong. [4]
 - (b) Why was the Tet Offensive important for the USA? [6]
 - (c) Which was more important for the USA, its involvement in Korea or the Cuban Missile Crisis? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/F/M/21

- 7 The USA resisted communism in various parts of the world.
- (a) Describe how the fighting in Korea came to an end in 1953. [4]
 - (b) Why was the Cuban Missile Crisis resolved peacefully? [6]
 - (c) Was it events in Vietnam or events in the USA that forced America to withdraw from Vietnam? Explain your answer. [10]